

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on experience supporting live legal matters in private practice, clinical and in-house settings. Experienced in reviewing and organising documents, maintaining case files, drafting correspondence and procedural materials, managing deadlines across concurrent matters and communicating clearly with clients and stakeholders. Background spans commercial disputes, real estate, data privacy and contract review, providing a broad foundation suited to in-house legal support across a diversified business group.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction (75%)

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from first client interview through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across a concurrent caseload
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law
- Translates complex rules and procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients in difficult circumstances

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time delivery
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator; maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Reviewed documents and prepared electronic hearing bundles; assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials across several concurrent matters
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records on iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing deadlines

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters